



RENEWABLE ENERGY

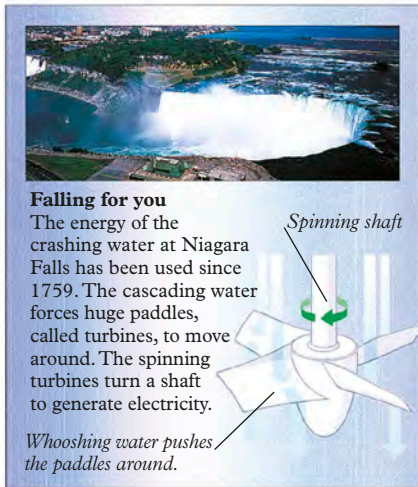


When oil, gas, and coal run out, people will need other sources of energy to fuel their cars and light their houses. Wind and water are already being put to work, but the best hope for a renewable supply of energy is the sun. Light and heat from the sun pour down onto Earth all the time. Today, sunshine runs everything from watches to power stations. One day scientists hope to collect sunlight in space, and beam it back to Earth!



What a gas!

In some countries manure is collected, dumped into containers, and left to rot. The gas it gives off is piped into homes and used for cooking and heating.



Falling for you

The energy of the crashing water at Niagara Falls has been used since 1759. The cascading water forces huge paddles, called turbines, to move around. The spinning turbines turn a shaft to generate electricity.

Whooshing water pushes the paddles around.

Not alone

The solar power station is faced by 63 small, flat mirrors. They reflect extra light onto the main mirror.

Trick of the light

This is the world's first solar power station. It was built in 1969 at Odeillo in France. Electricity is generated by using reflected sunlight to boil water into steam.

This enormous mirror is curved so that all the sunshine that hits it is reflected onto one small spot at the top of the tower.

Computers keep the 63 minimirrors facing the sun.

